

sound cards, it would be a total disappointment. The audio quality of headphones also depends on the sensitivity of the driver units. Lower the sensitivity of the driver is, better is the response to low frequency signals. While sounds tend to sound clearer are most of the noise and distortion is dampened at high frequency. Higher sensitivity drivers need lesser power to produce sound, but also get distorted at higher volumes. Headphones with driver units which are of low sensitivity need external power to deliver the full sound.

Almost all headphones work the same way – by driving magnets which cause a membrane to vibrate, producing sound. This is an analog system. One can argue that moving to a digital ports is a step forward but ultimately the production of sound is still an analog process. It would be interesting to see a solid state solution to producing sound, or a truly Digital Sound system which would be significant leap.

Headphones and earphones are here to stay. To illustrate the evolution of earphones, a prisoner, spending 43 years in solitary confinement in the US was released earlier this year. Among all the new things he spotted, what was particularly interesting was his observation about almost everyone wearing ‘wires’ in their ears leading him to believe there were so many people working for the CIA. He also commented on the way people were talking to themselves using these wires, showing how something so common place these days such as earphones and headsets were alien and very rare a few decades back. You can watch the video of the prisoner here : <http://dgit.in/rumplstskn>

While headphones and earphones are very useful gadgets, they must not be misused. People can suffer from permanent ear damage care should be taken to ensure that the listening volumes are comfortable and well below the threshold of pain. Wearing headphones while in dangerous or critical situations can be dangerous for individuals and might cause accidents and injury.

With good sound quality becoming a ubiquitous feature in modern smartphones and tablets, people are in constant pursuit of audio excellence, going the extra mile to ensure that the sounds they listen to are the best reproduction possible. It would be interesting to see drastic disruptions in the headphone market with the various manufacturers investing a lot of cash in R&D 